FOUNDER NETWORK · MEMBER RESOURCE

Alternative Capital Playbook

Understand the non-VC funding paths available to your business and how to pursue them.

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WHO IT'S FOR

Founders who assume venture capital is the only option.

WHEN TO USE IT

Before defaulting to an equity raise.

WHAT IT PRODUCES

A shortlist of alternative capital paths matched to your stage.

NEXT STEP INSIDE THE ECOSYSTEM

Qualify each path with the Founder Capital Access Toolkit (CAP-01). For a founder-specific capital strategy, move into a VGP advisory engagement; Growth OS keeps the resulting pipeline operating week to week.

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THE BRAND BLUEPRINT · Powered by Value Growth Partners · Growth OS

Alternative & Creative Capital Playbook

A Practical Guide for Founders Exploring Non-Dilutive & Flexible Funding

Purpose of This Guide

This guide outlines practical capital options beyond traditional venture capital to help founders compare costs, timelines, and eligibility.

Capital Types Covered

- CDFI Term Loans
- Revenue-Based Financing (RBF)
- Invoice Factoring
- State & Local Incentives
- Workforce Training Grants
- Regulation Crowdfunding (Reg CF)

Quick Comparison Overview

This section compares capital types by use case, cost, speed, dilution, and founder fit.

CDFI Term Loans

Mission-driven loans for underserved founders. Typical APR ranges from 9–28% with flexible underwriting.

Revenue-Based Financing

Non-dilutive capital repaid as a percentage of revenue. Best for consistent monthly sales.

Invoice Factoring

Sell unpaid invoices to accelerate cash flow. Fees typically range from 1–5% per month.

State & Local Incentives

Grants, credits, and loans tied to job creation, housing, and economic development.

Workforce Training Grants

Public funds to support employee training and upskilling initiatives.

Regulation Crowdfunding

Raise up to $5M annually from the public via SEC-regulated platforms.

Founder Profile Matching

Early-stage, revenue-generating, and B2B founders each align best with different capital stacks.

Advisory Note

Capital should be layered strategically. Non-dilutive options can extend runway without sacrificing ownership.